

LIVE FROM THE ROOM

SYMPHONY OF EXPERIENCE · HO CHI MINH
CITY

Sit anywhere Tables of 4 to 6

Scan and answer in 10
seconds.

Here with colleagues from your
company? Sit together.

no systemic change

no proof for bosses

leadership vs customer

fast with few resources

data, no action

cx roi unproven

What most gets in the way of
delivering a great customer
experience at your company? 8
answers

ADD YOURS



Dreamscape

SYMPHONY OF EXPERIENCE · HO CHI MINH CITY

HOSTED BY



XMGlobal
Collaborative

Work backwards from the smile.

Start with the experience. Follow it all the way back, and see what you end up with.

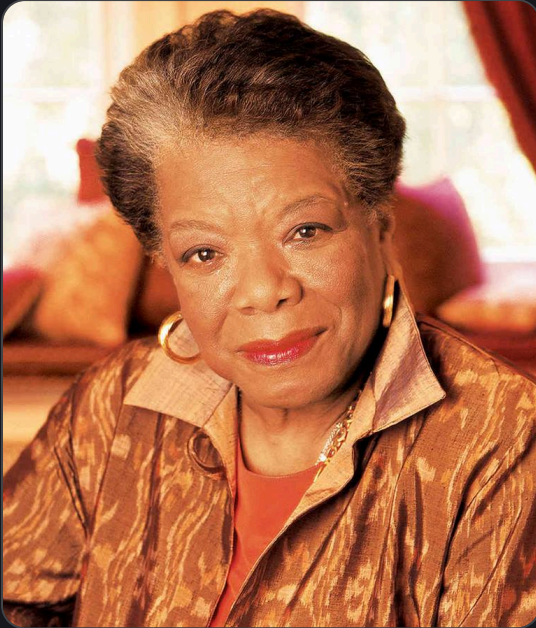
Joe Black · Dreamscope · 26 September 2026

Phones face down.

You get out what you put in.

Be honest at your table.





“I’ve learned that people will forget what you said, people will forget what you did, but people will never forget **how you made them feel.**”

Maya Angelou

READY

0:30

Take 30 seconds to
think about it.

+30 SEC

THIRTY SECONDS, ON YOUR OWN

The one customer experience you still tell people about.

Not a good one. The **great** one you can't stop
talking about.



Opening

1:00

ROUND THE TABLE, OR ROUND THE ROOM

One minute each.

30 seconds · who you are,
and what you do

30 seconds · the
experience you still tell
people about



01 / WHERE IT STARTS

You want loyal customers
who **refer you to their friends.**





A NORTH STAR, IN THE WILD

**“Every guest leaves
with a smile.”**

One sentence. It fell out of him while he was talking about what he actually wanted the restaurant to be.

Masuko, 4P's CEO



SAME JOB, DIFFERENT SCALE

NORTH STAR

Sets the direction in the moment.

One sentence that defines the experience your team delivers. Every interaction, every day.

VISION & MISSION

Sets the direction for the long term.

Where the company is going and why it exists.
However far out that is, is yours to choose.

Vision and Mission will not help the person standing in front of an unhappy customer right now. **That is the job the North Star was built for.**



02 / YOUR TURN

Now do it for *your company*.



HOLD IT IN YOUR HEAD FOR A SECOND

Maybe you already have one of these.
Maybe you have never written it down.

Either way, picture the experience
that makes **your** customer come
back and bring someone with them.

Got it.



Good.

I need a volunteer.



1 What experience do you want your customers to have?



WHAT YOU JUST DESCRIBED

That is your **North Star**.

One sentence that defines the experience your team delivers, every interaction, every day.

You can feel it

You can act on it



NOW YOURS

Your company. Your North Star.

You work on your own. If your whole table is from the same company, work together.



READY

2:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 1 · 2 MINUTES

Pick your own company.

The one you actually work at. Then write down who you serve. Be specific about the customer, not the market.



Breakout 1

READY

10:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 2 · 10 MINUTES

What do you want them to feel?

Then flip the lens. What do people complain
about today?



Breakout 1

READY

5:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 3 · 5 MINUTES

Narrow to your top three.

Cross out everything else. Three is the limit.



Breakout 1

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 4 · 5 MINUTES

Write the sentence.

One line. The test is not whether it sounds good on a wall. It is whether it helps you in the worst five minutes of your week, when somebody is unhappy in front of you, there is nobody senior to ask, and you have to decide what to do right now.

Short enough to
repeat from memory

Emotional. You can
feel it.

Actionable. It tells you
what to do in the
moment.

It sounds like your
company, not a
brochure.



READY

5:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

YOU ARE IN GOOD COMPANY

Write yours. 5 minutes.

PIZZA 4P'S

"Every guest leaves with a smile"

RITZ-CARLTON

"We are ladies and gentlemen
serving ladies and gentlemen"

ZAPPOS

"Deliver WOW through service"

STARBUCKS (ADAPTED)

"Make every visit feel like a
warm welcome"

TRADER JOE'S (ADAPTED)

"Make grocery shopping
surprisingly fun"

YOUR TURN

Write yours in your worksheet

Short enough to repeat
from memory

Emotional. You can feel it.

Actionable. It tells you what to
do in the moment.

It sounds like your company,
not a brochure.



Breakout 1

READY

10:00

+1 MIN

BREAK

Back in 10
minutes.



Break

YOU HAVE THE WHAT

Now the how.

You know the experience you want people to have. That is the easy half. The hard half is what has to be true every day for anyone to actually get that experience.



2 How would your people have to **behave**, every day, for your customer to get that?



5:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 1 OF 2 · 5 MINUTES

What would people actually DO?

To deliver the promise you just wrote, what do people do? Five or six of them. Specific enough that you could stand in the corner and count it.

GOOD EXAMPLE

“Greet every person within ten seconds.”

“Guide them. Do not point.”

“Anticipate needs and offer to help.”

BAD EXAMPLE

Not this: “Be customer focused.” You cannot watch somebody do that.



3:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 2 OF 2 · 3 MINUTES

Now look at your list. What is behind it?

What kind of person does all of those things? Name it. Three words that describe the behavior behind your actions: the thing they have in common.

Greet within ten seconds · Guide them, do not point · Anticipate needs and offer help



Hospitable · **Attentive** · **Proactive**

Three of those. That is what you are after.



WHY WE DID NOT STOP AT THE ACTIONS

A behavior writes the actions you never thought of.

THREE ACTIONS

People do those three things. In the situation nobody scripted, there is nothing to go on.

THREE BEHAVIORS

Hospitable, attentive, proactive. Those show up in a hundred ways you never had to write down.

The action tells someone what to do. **The behavior tells them why, and the why travels.**



WHAT YOU JUST CRAFTED

Those behaviors **are your values.**

Not the words on the wall. The things everyone is expected to do, every day, without being asked.

**You just wrote a culture.
Backwards, from the customer.**



READY

7:00

+1 MIN

7 MINUTES

Put it together.

On the landscape page of your worksheet, write it out:

My North Star is _____.

To deliver it, my team needs to be _____,
_____ and _____.



Then scan and type the same thing in. It goes straight up on the screen.



Breakout 2

3 How do you get them to
behave that way
reliably? Not on a good
day. **Every day.**

Hands up.
What do
you think?



THERE IS ONLY ONE ANSWER, AND IT IS ALWAYS THE SAME

Systems.

Who you hire

How you onboard

How you train

How you meet

What and when you recognize

What you measure

How you decide

Values are a tool. A tool has no power on its own. The system is the behavior around the tool.



WHERE MOST COMPANIES LOSE IT

They hand culture to HR and change nothing about how the work gets done.

Most systems on that list belong to operations. Built properly, your culture is a strategic element of the business, not a program running beside it.



SAME LIST, SORTED BY WHO ACTUALLY RUNS IT

Systems.

HR

Crickets.

HR + OPERATIONS

Who you hire

How you onboard

How you train

What and when you recognize

OPERATIONS

How you meet

What you measure

How you decide





HOW THIS LOOKS IN PRACTICE · PIZZA 4P'S

4.89 → 4.91

Google rating, up while the company grew from 2,200 to 3,700 people.

+5% to +20%

Mystery shopper scores.

One of the reasons: **every SOP and training rewritten to carry the why.**

THE GUIDELINE

Greet every guest within 10 seconds.

WHAT HAPPENED

Greeted in 10 seconds. Then ignored for 10 minutes.

THE PARTNER

“If the guest is upset, that’s your fault. I followed your guideline.”

The why: **Omotenashi**, the Japanese spirit of hospitality. Nobody who understands it ignores a guest for ten minutes.



2:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 1 OF 2 · 2 MINUTES

Which of these already help?

Who you hire

How you onboard

How you train

How you meet

What and when you recognize

What you measure

How you decide

On your worksheet, tick the ones that already push people towards the behaviors you wrote.

Be honest. Most people tick one or two. The blank ones are where the opportunity is.



READY

5:00

+1 MIN

ON YOUR OWN

STEP 2 OF 2 · 5 MINUTES

Pick one. Write the change.

One system off that list. On your worksheet, write the one specific change that would make it push people towards your behaviors.

FOR EXAMPLE

Recognition. At the end of every shift, name one person who did one of my three behaviors.

Something you could start on your own. If it needs a budget and a committee, make it smaller.



Breakout 2

READY

3:00

+1 MIN

SHARE

HANDS UP

Which system did you pick, and
what would you change?



Breakout 2

WHEN YOU REGISTERED, YOU ANSWERED ONE QUESTION

**“What most gets in the way
of delivering a great customer
experience at your company?”**

Here is what you said.

If you haven't answered yet, scan here
to answer.



nobody owns cx no systemic change
no proof for bosses leadership vs customer
fast with few resources
data, no action cx roi unproven
customers change faster

What most gets in the way of delivering a great customer experience at your company? **8 answers**

ADD YOURS



ONE THING ABOUT THAT LIST

**Every word on it came from
someone in this room.**

**Not one came from the
people doing the work.**

Solve that list and you may fix nothing at all.



Ask the people who live inside the systems you just designed.

Not a 60-question annual survey nobody reads. A short one, in their own language, where every free-text answer is read and classified rather than counted.

Under 5 minutes

Any language

Anonymized

Answers in days, not months

Show the actions taken



AND YES, THAT IS A LOT OF WORK

**Culture, skills, systems,
motivation. Miss one and the
picture never completes.**

There is a word for the completed picture, and it has been measured for twenty years.



Engagement.

TOP QUARTILE VERSUS BOTTOM QUARTILE

+23%

profitability

+10%

customer loyalty

Gallup Q12 meta-analysis, 11th edition, 2024



03 / TAKE THIS BACK WITH YOU

Three questions. Fifteen minutes. A whiteboard.

It works on your team, your board, and the person who thinks none of this is their job. Ask in order, let them answer, and they build the case themselves in their own words.



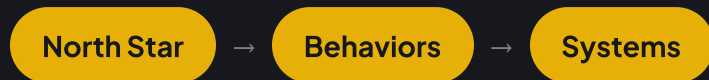
TAKE A PHOTO OF THIS ONE

- 1 What experience do you want your customers to have?
- 2 How would your people have to **behave**, every day, for your customer to get that?
- 3 How do you get them to behave that way reliably? Not on a good day. **Every day.**

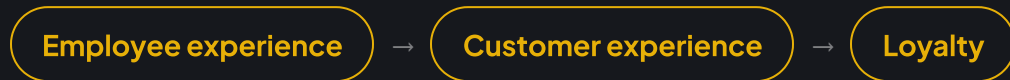


WHERE EX AND CX STOP BEING TWO DEPARTMENTS

WHAT YOU BUILD



WHAT YOU GET



This is the **Symphony of Experience.**

An audience hears two hours. The performance was made in the hundreds of hours nobody watched.



THIS MORNING

Look at what you built.

ONE

North Star

THREE

Behaviors

ONE

System change

Three hours ago, none of that existed.



Close

ONE LAST THING

Don't make this a big deal.

Treat it as a project and it gets scoped, staffed and postponed. Keep it simple. Ask your people what gets in the way, and let them tell you what to fix first.

**Build a better place to work and you build
a better company to be a customer of.**

If you want help with any of it, come find me.



Dreamscope

**Everything works
better if people
love what they do.**

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dreamscope.win

Want my two cents on what you built? There is a link on that page.

Over to Vi

Thank you to XMGlobal Collaborative



XMGlobal
Collaborative

